

Minimalistic Theme

A content-first Beamer system for clear academic and professional presentations

Beamer Atelier

Design Studio Executive

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Outline

- **Content First Design**
- **Beamer Atelier**
- **The Minimalistic Theme**
 - Identity and Design Language
 - Features
- **Theme Environments**
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 - Table & Graphic Environment
- **Conclusion**

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● **Content First Design**

○ **Beamer Atelier**

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○ **Conclusion**

Presentation design should not compete with content

- Many presentation themes add visual activity before clarifying the message.
- Decorative elements can distract from arguments, equations, tables, and evidence.
- Minimalistic begins from a different principle: the content should remain in the foreground.
- The design system should support reading, structure, and calm progression.
- A good slide should help the presenter communicate, not ask the audience to admire the template.

Why simplicity feels intellectually serious

- Simple layouts make hierarchy easier to understand.
- Consistent spacing helps the audience follow long explanations.
- Restrained design reduces visual fatigue across lectures, workshops, and research talks.
- The result is not plainness, but composure.

Why systematic presenters need minimal design

- Researchers need slides that can handle concepts, models, tables, and references.
- Teachers need layouts that remain readable across a full lecture.
- Consultants and institutional presenters need professional consistency without visual excess.
- Technical presenters need mathematics and evidence to look native, not forced into decoration.

Minimalism supports disciplined workflow

- Content and design can be separated cleanly.
- Theme files enforce visual consistency across all slides.
- Structural changes can be made globally rather than slide by slide.
- Long presentations remain manageable because hierarchy is embedded in the source.
- This is especially valuable for recurring teaching, conference speaking, and branded institutional work.

From visual restraint to credibility

- A calm presentation system signals care, seriousness, and authorship.
- Viewers may not notice the theme, but they notice the clarity of the final result.
- Minimalistic rewards presenters who value stability over visual noise.
- In that sense, it is not just a theme. It is a disciplined working environment.

Why themes matter inside Beamer

- Beamer provides the structural foundation, but the theme determines the experience (Block et al., 2017).
- A weak theme can make a strong document feel generic or crowded.
- A strong theme gives rhythm to titles, sections, equations, tables, and dense content.
- The best themes do not compete with the message. They quietly discipline it.

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What Beamer Atelier stands for

- Beamer Atelier builds themes as presentation systems, not decorative templates.
- The goal is to produce slides that feel intentional, calm, and intellectually grounded.
- Our themes are shaped by the belief that good design should reduce friction rather than attract attention to itself.
- We value visual order because order improves comprehension.

Our philosophy of restraint

- Restraint means deliberate design absence in service of understanding.
- We remove unnecessary visual noise so that hierarchy can speak clearly.
- We avoid novelty for its own sake.
- We prefer systems that remain elegant over a full lecture, workshop, or conference talk.
- Quiet design often produces stronger professional authority than expressive clutter.

The four layers of restraint

- **Visual restraint:** limited color, stable geometry, careful emphasis.
- **Cognitive restraint:** less distraction, less scanning effort, cleaner attention flow.
- **Pedagogical restraint:** designs that teach with patience rather than overwhelm.
- **Strategic restraint:** reusable systems that continue to work across contexts.

The values that guide our themes

- Clarity before ornament.
- Structure before decoration.
- Reusability before improvisation.
- Readability before density.
- Professional calm before visual excitement.

Why this matters in teaching and research

- Lectures often fail when slides look active but communicate weakly.
- Research presentations often fail when strong ideas are wrapped in unstable design.
- A disciplined theme reduces these risks by creating predictable visual behavior.
- Predictability is not dullness. In serious presentations, it is trust.

A theme should shape presenter behavior

- A well-designed theme nudges the author toward better decisions.
- It encourages sectioning, proportion, clean titles, and logical progression.
- It rewards careful composition instead of last-minute formatting.
- In this way, theme design becomes part of presentation pedagogy.

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What Minimalistic is

- Minimalistic is a Beamer theme built for content-first academic and professional communication.
- It is designed for presenters who want clarity, readability, and calm visual behavior.
- Its visual language is intentionally quiet, but not generic.
- It uses spacing, typography, alignment, and hierarchy to create identity without decoration.

Minimalistic's visual character

- A clean white canvas gives the content room to breathe.
- A restrained accent system supports emphasis without dominating the slide.
- Typography carries hierarchy rather than ornamental geometry.
- Mathematical and technical content remains central to the theme.
- The result feels simple, serious, and presentation-ready.

Built for long-form presentations

- Minimalistic is especially effective when a presentation has many sections and many slides.
- It helps maintain readability over time rather than optimizing only for isolated showcase pages.
- This makes it suitable for:
 - ▶ university lectures,
 - ▶ technical workshops,
 - ▶ thesis defenses,
 - ▶ conference presentations,
 - ▶ institutional briefings.

A title page that stays quiet

- Minimalistic includes a clean title page with clear spatial hierarchy.
- The title, subtitle, author block, institute, and date are carefully separated.
- The page establishes tone without relying on heavy visual devices.
- It feels formal, calm, and ready for academic or professional use.

Outline page as orientation device

- Minimalistic provides a dedicated outline slide through `\makeoutline`.
- The outline helps the audience understand the structure of the talk.
- It avoids decorative complexity and focuses on orientation.
- This is useful both at the start of the talk and before major transitions.

Section pages that create calm rhythm

- Each section begins with a dedicated section slide.
- Minimalistic uses section pages as quiet pauses rather than dramatic interruptions.
- The section title remains clear, centered, and easy to process.
- This gives the audience a moment of orientation without breaking the tone of the talk.

Frametitles with minimal intervention

- Minimalistic replaces visual heaviness with clean title hierarchy.
- The frametitle is designed to identify the slide without overpowering it.
- The body area remains open for arguments, equations, tables, and figures.
- Because the title treatment is standardized, the content can remain visually calm.

Navigation without distraction

- Minimalistic supports orientation while avoiding excessive interface elements.
- The audience should always know where they are without constantly seeing the theme.
- Navigation is treated as support, not decoration.
- This keeps attention on the present slide and the speaker's argument.

Whitespace as a structural instrument

- Minimalistic uses whitespace to create separation and hierarchy.
- Empty space is not unused space; it is part of the reading system.
- It helps equations, bullet points, and figures sit comfortably on the slide.
- This is especially important for technical and teaching presentations.

Theme options and flexibility

- Section page can be disabled using `nosectionpage`.
- The accent color is user-overridable through `Theme_Color`.
- This means Minimalistic can adapt to institutional palettes.
- The underlying system remains stable even when branding changes.

A complete presentation journey

- Minimalistic supports the full lifecycle of a professional deck:
 - ▶ title page,
 - ▶ outline,
 - ▶ section transitions,
 - ▶ content slides,
 - ▶ theorem and technical environments,
 - ▶ references,
 - ▶ thank-you slide.
- This makes the theme feel complete rather than partial.

Thank-you slide and closing discipline

- Minimalistic includes a dedicated thank-you slide command.
- The closing screen matches the visual language of the rest of the deck.
- This matters because endings are often rushed or visually inconsistent in many presentations.
- Minimalistic keeps the final impression composed and intentional.

References support

- Minimalistic includes a simple references frame environment for bibliography slides.
- This is particularly useful for academic talks and research-based teaching.
- It allows bibliography content to remain integrated within the presentation system.
- Even peripheral slides feel native to the theme.

Why Minimalistic works as a sellable theme

- It has a clear content-first identity.
- It solves real presenter problems: readability, consistency, technical content, and calm delivery.
- It supports complete workflows instead of isolated showcase slides.
- It is restrained enough to be widely usable, but disciplined enough to feel professionally authored.

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Theorem Example

Theorem 4.1: Gauss–Markov Theorem

Under the classical linear regression assumptions, the OLS estimator $\hat{\beta} = (X'X)^{-1}X'y$ is the Best Linear Unbiased Estimator (BLUE).

Math Example: OLS Estimation

Equation 1: Ordinary Least Squares Estimator

$$\hat{\beta} = (X'X)^{-1}X'y$$

Equation 2: Variance of OLS

$$\text{Var}(\hat{\beta}) = \sigma^2(X'X)^{-1}$$

As shown in Equation 1, the estimator is derived from minimizing the residual sum of squares.

Table Example: What to Do in a Good Presentation

What to Do	What Not to Do
Clarity in structure	Overcrowded slides
Consistent typography	Random font changes
Minimal color palette	Excessive decorative elements
Logical mathematical flow	Jumping between disconnected ideas

Graphic Example

Figure 1: Structured Visual Identity



Figure 1 illustrates how graphics integrate naturally within the Minimalistic theme frame.

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- A vertical line on the left side of the slide, with circular markers at each item. The bottom marker is a solid dark blue circle, while the others are light gray.
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What this presentation has shown

- Beamer is compelling because it turns presentations into structured systems.
- Beamer Atelier builds on that foundation through restraint, hierarchy, and pedagogical intent.
- Minimalistic translates those values into a practical content-first theme for real academic and professional use.
- Its strength lies not only in appearance, but in the calm and disciplined experience it creates across an entire deck.

Minimalistic in one sentence

Minimalistic is a **content-first Beamer theme** for presenters who want their slides to feel **clear, calm, rigorous, readable, and professionally authored.**

Closing message

- Good presentation design is not about adding more.
- It is about deciding what should remain.
- Minimalistic is built around that belief.

Thank you!

References

Block, L., Hoof, S., and Stroh-Maraun, N. (2017). Introduction to latex beamer.